

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It's not just for eating!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- Besides eating, what are some other uses for food that you know of?
- Do you use any food as medical remedies? Which ones?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about myths and legends, culture and traditions.
- I can talk about past situations that did not happen.
- I can scan a text for important information.





Let's Explore!

Some foods can **alleviate***hunger and pain.

* To "alleviate" means to make something bad such as pain or problems less severe

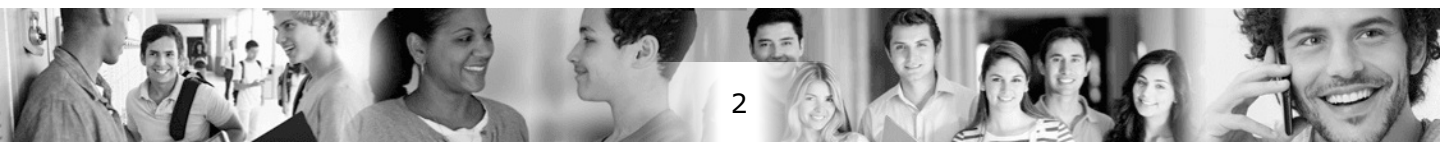


Instructions: Read the text aloud.

For many years, people have connected food to what happens to them. Long ago, one could find many interesting legends on food. People had wanted to believe these legends but they weren't scientifically proven to be true. Some are quite strange! Mushrooms were often thought of as evil, perhaps because they were connected with fairies who were "seen" dancing on them. On the other hand, in Southeast Asia, finding mushrooms at the beginning of a trip meant that a person would be lucky. Travelers report that they had feared a difficult trip but when they saw a mushroom everything turned out to be fine.

In ancient Greece, beans were banned because people believed they brought bad dreams and madness. However, the ancient Egyptians believed beans had a soul and worshipped them. As for healing powers of food, in Ireland people believed that potatoes had the ability to cure aches and pains. People would even walk around with potatoes in socks hung around their necks to avoid getting sore throats. They would rub potatoes on their skin to heal burns. People had expected potatoes to cure their ailments but it didn't always work. Known to be one of the oldest plants frequently used as a medicine, garlic has relieved ailments from coughs to fevers. If garlic is topically applied, it can help heal skin conditions like eczema and scabies, and prevent hair from going grey. Oddly enough, in the past, it was given to "hysterical" girls because it was thought to calm them down if it was rubbed on their noses! People had hoped that garlic could improve emotional well-being but it wasn't effective.

Even today, certain foods are believed to have healing powers. People eat cloves of raw garlic to prevent colds and flu, and honey to soothe a sore throat. Pharmaceutical companies that had expected to take over the healing business, haven't been able to beat some of these natural and ancient remedies.





Let's Practice!

Let's talk about the healing powers of potatoes and garlic!

Instructions: Read the text. Underline all the information related to healing and illnesses. Practice saying the text aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

People would even walk around with potatoes in socks hung around their necks to avoid getting sore throats. They would rub potatoes on their skin to heal burns. People had expected potatoes to cure their ailments but it didn't always work. Garlic is one of the oldest plants to be widely used as a medicine. Garlic has been taken to relieve coughs and fevers or applied externally to prevent greying of hair and improve skin conditions like eczema and scabies. People had hoped that garlic could improve emotional well-being but it wasn't effective.



Let's Practice!

Here are some more interesting myths about food and health.

Instructions: Circle the correct words to complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. People had wanted to **believe** / **believing** / **believes** these legends but they weren't scientifically proven to be true.
2. Travelers report that they had **fear** / **feared** / **fearing** a difficult trip but when they saw a mushroom everything turned out to be fine.
3. People had **expected** / **expect** / **expecting** potatoes to cure their ailments but it didn't always work.
4. People had **hope** / **hoped** / **hopes** that garlic could improve emotional well-being but it wasn't effective.
5. Pharmaceutical companies had **expect** / **expects** / **expected** to take over the healing business, but they haven't been able to beat some of these natural and ancient remedies.





Extension Activity

Research traditional uses of food.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On the Internet, research traditional uses of food.
- Make a list of some traditional uses of food from around the world.
- Choose one and do more research.
- Make a poster that shows the food that you chose, its traditional uses and its current uses, if any.
- Present your poster and research to your class or group.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research traditional uses of food.

☐ ☐

I make a poster to show the traditional uses of food.

☐ ☐

I present my poster to a group.

☐ ☐

I present my research findings to a group.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to ban** (verb): to refuse to allow something, especially officially
e.g. In ancient Greece, beans were banned because people believed they brought bad dreams and madness.
- madness** (noun): insanity
e.g. Madness can be a problem among homeless people.
- ailment** (noun): medical problem
e.g. People had expected potatoes to cure their ailments but it didn't always work.
- to cure** (verb): to make someone with an illness healthy again
e.g. In Ireland people believed that potatoes had the ability to cure aches and pains.
- eczema** (noun): skin condition in which areas of the skin become red, rough, and sore
e.g. If garlic is topically applied, it can help heal skin conditions like eczema and scabies.
- to soothe** (verb): to make a part of the body less painful
e.g. People eat cloves of raw garlic to prevent colds and flu, and honey to soothe a sore throat.
- pharmaceutical** (adjective): relating to the production of medicines
e.g. Pharmaceutical companies had expected to take over the healing business, but they haven't been able to beat some of these natural and ancient remedies.
- to prevent** (verb): to stop something from happening
e.g. Garlic has been applied externally to prevent hair from going grey.





Learning Points

The Past Perfect to Describe Unfulfilled Plans

You can use the Past Perfect tense to talk about unfulfilled events. These are things that you wanted to do, but for some reason they did not happen.

You use the Past Perfect with report verbs and with *hope*, *intend*, *expect* to talk about plans that have not yet been fulfilled.

When you use these types of constructions in speaking, you stress the word *had*.

Practice reading these sentences aloud:

*I **had** hoped to talk to him but he was too busy to listen.*

*I **had** thought of texting him but decided against it.*

Examples:

- *People had wanted to believe these legends but they weren't scientifically proven to be true.*
- *People had expected potatoes to cure their ailments but it didn't always work.*
- *Pharmaceutical companies had expected to take over the healing business, but they haven't been able to beat some of these natural and ancient remedies.*
- *Travelers report that they had feared a difficult trip but when they saw a mushroom everything turned out to be fine.*
- *People had hoped that garlic could improve emotional well-being but it wasn't effective.*

Scanning a Text

Scanning is a reading skill. It involves looking at a text quickly in order to identify specific information.

You use scanning when you want to find a specific name, date, time, statistic or fact without reading the whole text.

These are some things to keep in mind in order to scan a text effectively:

1. *Keep the idea or image of what you are looking for in mind as you scan. This helps you to find it quickly.*
2. *Try to anticipate what form the information you want will appear in (nouns, verbs etc.).*
3. *Analyze the organization of the text before you scan.*
4. *Let your eyes quickly glance at several sentences at a time.*
5. *When you find the sentence with the detail you want, read the entire sentence.*

